

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Signal the close -> Give a warm and honest reason -> End clean

START HERE

Signal your exit before you actually leave. Give one brief, honest reason. End the conversation cleanly rather than trailing off.

SAY THIS

Exit Signals	<i>"I want to wrap up shortly — "</i>
Warm Exit Phrases	<i>"This was a really useful conversation — thank you."</i>
Meeting Exits	<i>"I have a hard stop at three — I want to use the last five minutes on next steps."</i>
Naming the Exit	<i>"I am going to head off now."</i>
Leaving Tense Conve...	<i>"I do not want to leave this on a sour note — thank you for being straight with me."</i>

AVOID

- When the other person is in distress and leaving would feel like abandonment.
- When there is unfinished critical business that genuinely needs resolution before the conversation closes.
- When your exit will be read as avoidance of something difficult.

REMEMBER

Signal first — the exit itself should never be a surprise.